



How to build a **FAST** channel

The eleven steps to stand up a free ad-supported linear channel — and how the distribution platforms actually work.

Part 1 • The build checklist

A FAST channel is a 24/7 linear HLS stream with ad-break markers, an EPG and a brand. Whether you build it yourself or hand it to Asiko, these are the pieces.

1

Define the channel

Name, genre, target audience, primary language, and the markets you want it available in. A tight editorial idea beats a broad one — "Nollywood classics," not "movies."

2

Secure content & rights

- ◆ Streaming (not just broadcast) rights for your territories, for the window you want.
- ◆ Music clearance for everything in the content.
- ◆ Either a **library** — 20–40+ hours to start, ideally more so it doesn't feel repetitive — or a **genuine live feed** for sport / news / events.

3

Encode & package to HLS

Transcode every asset to **one consistent ladder** — same resolutions, codec, keyframe/GOP cadence, audio. Mismatched profiles break playback at ad splice points. Output HLS (TS or CMAF). Tools: Eyevinn Encore, AWS MediaConvert, Cloudflare Stream, FFmpeg.

4

Store it behind a CDN

Put the packaged files where a playout engine and a CDN can both read them over HTTP — object storage (Bunny, R2, S3) with a CDN in front. For Asiko: Bunny.

5

Build a schedule & EPG

Lay the library into a 24/7 schedule. Export it as **XMLTV** or **MRSS** — now, next, and at least 24–72 hours forward, refreshed on change. The EPG is separate from the video: it's metadata the guide

reads.

6

Run the playout

- ♦ **VOD2Live** — an engine loops/schedules your files into one continuous HLS stream. Cheap, no live encoder, very reliable. Eyevinn Channel Engine does this.
- ♦ **Live encoder** — only for genuine live. Needs an uplink and is fragile; always pair with a backup source and a fallback slate.

7

Mark the ad breaks

Insert **SCTE-35** markers in the manifest at each break (`#EXT-X-CUE-OUT/IN`), or provide an EPG precise enough to derive them. Decide your pod structure — breaks per hour, slots per break, slot length. Typical FAST load: 8–14 min/hour.

8

Prepare brand assets

Channel logo (SVG + PNG on transparent, readable on dark), an on-screen bug, a still "off-air" slate, and optional break bumpers.

9

Choose distribution

Direct to each platform, or — the practical route — one **aggregator** that fans your single feed out to many platforms. See Part 2.

10

Wire up monetisation

Server-side ad insertion (SSAI) against your SCTE-35, calling an ad decision server (SpringServe, Publica, Google Ad Manager) — or let the distribution platform's ad stack handle it and take a rev-share. Add house promos to backfill unsold slots.

11

Monitor, log, reconcile

24/7 monitoring with alerting, as-run logs, and a monthly reconciliation of ad-server revenue against buyer reports. This is ongoing operations, not a launch task.

With Asiko you do steps 1, 2, 5, 8 and hand us a feed (or files + schedule). Asiko does 3–4 (normalisation), 6–7 (playout & SCTE-35), 9–11 (distribution, monetisation, ops). See the *List Your Channel* pack and the *Channel Owner Q&A*.

Part 2 • The platforms, and how each works

Every FAST platform ingests a linear feed, wraps it in their app and guide, sells or brokers the ads, and rev-shares with the channel owner. What differs is **how you get on** and **who controls the ads**.

PLATFORM	WHAT IT IS	HOW A CHANNEL GETS ON	ADS & ECONOMICS
Asiko TV	Diaspora / Africa FAST — web now, CTV apps rolling out	Send an HLS feed, or files + a schedule. Asiko normalises, runs playout, inserts ads, distributes.	Asiko sells; rev-share to you (typ. 50/70% owner). Reserved-pods option you sell some yourself.
Roku — The Roku Channel	The largest US FAST surface	A Roku Partner account; submit a linear feed + program metadata. Or a "Direct Publisher" / Independent channel you build.	Roku sells the ads and rev-shares (often ~60/40 to Roku, negotiable). Roku's scale. Roku's rules.
Amazon Fire TV / Freevee	Amazon's linear + AVOD	Curation-heavy — usually an invite or a content/licensing deal, or via an aggregator. Feed-based.	Amazon sells the rev-share. Harder to get on directly.
Samsung TV Plus	Built into every Samsung TV; very large	Almost always via an aggregator (Amagi, Wurl...). Samsung curates hard.	Samsung sells the ads; rev-share through the aggregator.
LG Channels	Built into LG TVs; powered by Zeasn / XUMO	Via an aggregator or the tech partner. Curated.	Platform sells; rev-share.
Xumo Play / Vizio WatchFree+	Xumo is Comcast + Charter; also powers Vizio	Direct deal or aggregator.	Platform sells; rev-share.
Pluto TV	Paramount-owned, one of the originals	Curated and slow — usually a content deal or via an aggregator. Hard to get on directly.	Pluto sells everything; content-licensing or rev-share deals.

PLATFORM	WHAT IT IS	HOW A CHANNEL GETS ON	ADS & ECONOMICS
Tubi	Fox-owned; mostly AVOD, growing FAST ("Tubi channels")	Content-licensing deals; feed for the linear channels.	Tubi sells; licensing fee or rev-share
Plex · Sling Freestream · Local Now · Rakuten TV	Smaller / regional FAST surfaces	Direct or aggregator; each has its own portal.	Platform or shared ad sales; rev-share.
Free-to-air satellite (e.g. how AVO reaches Africa on Intelsat 20)	Not streaming — a broadcast transponder	A transponder / uplink deal with a satellite operator. Capital-heavy, separate skill set.	Sold as a broadcast channel; no addressable ad tech.

Aggregators — the route most channel owners actually take

Integrating each platform is months of work. An aggregator takes your **one feed** and does the rest: format each platform's spec, handle ad ops and SSAI, deliver EPG, consolidate reporting, and pay you a single rev-share.

- ◆ **Amagi** — the market leader; playout + SSAI + distribution + analytics, cloud-based.
- ◆ **Wurl** (Roku-owned) — distribution + ad monetisation across CTV.
- ◆ **Frequency, Glewed TV, Zeasn/Whale** — similar, various strengths.

Where Asiko sits: for African and diaspora content, Asiko is the direct, fastest route with a rev-share that isn't diluted by a chain of intermediaries. Longer term Asiko can itself be your aggregator to the global platforms, or you run Asiko alongside an aggregator for the others — listing is non-exclusive.

Part 3 · Quick decision guide

YOUR SITUATION	BEST ROUTE
African/diaspora content, want to launch fast, small team	List with Asiko — feed or files, and you're on in days.
You have a live feed + backup and want broad CTV reach now	Asiko + an aggregator (Amagi / Wurl) for the global platforms. Non-exclusive.

YOUR SITUATION	BEST ROUTE
Only a content library, no playout	Asiko builds the channel for you (VOD2Live) from your library + schedule
You want to keep selling your own ads	Reserved-pods deal — you fill some slots, the platform fills the rest.
Genuine 24/7 live (news/sport)	Live encoder + backup + slate → feed to Asiko / aggregator. Consider a VOD2Live "base" channel with live windows spliced in.

Asiko TV — FAST channel creation checklist & platform guide

Media Icons Africa · 7 September 2026 · pairs with the List Your Channel pack and the Channel Owner Q&A

